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Kodu: The game changer

What could be a better way to welcome the new year than with a DIY on creating your own animated game using Kodu Game Lab?



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If you're bored of crushing the same old candies, if the fruits have gotten too stale to slice like a 'ninja' anymore, and if pitting plants and zombies against each other feels 'oh so 2014', perhaps it's time to channel the tedium of these hackneyed games into something productive. Try your hand at making an original game with Microsoft's 'Kodu Game Lab', a free game developing software

that's also the simplest one around. With no coding skills or a game developing background required to tinker around with it, building a brand new game of your own has never been easier.

If the number of technical specs confuses you, worry not, they are present in even the most basic computers. Kodu is also available as an Xbox 360 Indie Game.

Interface

Kodu, apart from being the name of the software, is a character that evolves around every game you make. It helps users avoid having to type in the codes by having them construct programs using visual elements. Moreover, rather than a bitmapped or 2D display, programs are executed in a 3D simulation environment, similar to Alice [<http://dgit.in/AliceProjj>].



Kodu lets you choose an existing world or create a new one

All about Kodu

Kodu is a new visual programming language made specifically for creating games. With a children-friendly and all-round enjoyable composition, the language's visual nature allows for rapid design using an Xbox game controller or a mouse and a keyboard for input.

How to get it

All you need to do is to visit www.kodugamelab.com and follow the instructions to download it (File size: 197.1 MB). You will need the following things:

- Operating System - Windows (7, 8.x, 10, Vista, or XP).
- Graphics card - One that supports DirectX 9.0c,
- Shader Model 2.0 or higher
- .NET Framework 4.0 or higher
- XNA Framework 4.0 Redistributable



The lower middle part of the screen has all the tools you need

After you open Kodu, in the main menu, you will have the option to either load a pre-made world or make a new one. Once you do that, you will get all the tools to make a game on the lower middle part of the screen. There are more than hundreds of worlds to choose from.

The very basic tools include:

- Run Tool - Used to play the game.
- Object Tool - Used to add, move, and program characters.
- Up/Down - Used to lower or raise a part of the terrain.
- Ground Brush - Used to add and delete arena.

Also, from the 'Help' menu, you can find answers to all the questions you might have about Kodu.

Making a simple game

First and foremost, you don't have to start from scratch. You can simply load a world and make a few or many changes to create